

8.4.3 OpenOffice.org

OpenOffice is a free, open source, cross platform office application suite. According to its mission statement, the OpenOffice.org project aims *“to create, as a community, the leading international office suite that will run on all major platforms and provide access to all functionality and data through open-component based APIs and an XML-based file format.”*

OpenOffice.org is a collection of applications including a word processor called Writer, a spreadsheet application called Calc, a presentation program called Impress, a database program called Base, and a graphics editor called Draw.



Design 3D presentations with Keynote!

One negative of OpenOffice on OS X is that it does not have a Mac-native interface. Besides, you need to install XII from the OS X DVD in order to run OpenOffice. This is a major issue, especially for professionals. There is another project, NeoOffice, based on OpenOffice; it offers a Mac-native interface.

However, OpenOffice.org is a very good office application suite that enjoys a huge advantage over Microsoft because of its features, ease of use, and the fact that it's free.